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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Amazon agreed to pay \$2.5 billion to settle Federal Trade Commission allegations that it duped tens of millions of customers into signing up for its Prime service and made it very difficult for them to cancel.** **A1**
- ◆ **The Supreme Court is poised to decide whether Trump can remove Lisa Cook from the Fed's board in a case that economists say threatens to erode decades of central bank independence.** **A1**
- ◆ **Trump unveiled new tariffs, including a large one on drugmakers that aren't building plants in the U.S.** **A5**
- ◆ **The U.S. economy grew at a much stronger pace this spring than previously realized, a revised estimate showed.** **A2**
- ◆ **Sales of existing homes fell 0.2% in August from the prior month as high prices kept transactions in check despite easing mortgage rates.** **A2**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes fell for a third straight session, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq both declining 0.5% and the Dow retreating 0.4%.** **B9**
- ◆ **Financial regulators have examined unusual trading patterns in the shares of companies that sought to make buying cryptocurrencies their core corporate strategy.** **B1**
- ◆ **Microsoft disabled the Israeli Defense Ministry's access to certain services after finding that it used the company's cloud services to surveil Gaza citizens.** **B1**
- ◆ **A Goldman Sachs investment vehicle plans to quit the London Stock Exchange, having struggled to attract investor interest.** **B10**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The U.S. government is hurtling toward a shutdown in a matter of days with no exit ramp in sight, as Republicans and Democrats latch on to starkly different positions and the White House threatens to lay off more federal workers.** **A1**
- ◆ **The Justice Department charged former FBI director James Comey with making false statements and obstruction, securing an indictment days after Trump demanded the prosecution and ousted the U.S. attorney who hadn't found cause to bring it.** **A1**
- ◆ **The Justice Department told federal prosecutors to draft plans to investigate a group funded by liberal philanthropist George Soros amid an escalating crackdown on Trump's opponents.** **A3**
- ◆ **Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth ordered generals and admirals to gather for an urgent meeting near Washington on Tuesday, surprising senior military officers and stirring some consternation in their ranks.** **A5**
- ◆ **Trump suggested that he is open to lifting sanctions on Turkey and selling it F-35 jet fighters, and he called for the country to stop buying oil and gas from Russia.** **A7**
- ◆ **Trump said he would block Israel from annexing the West Bank, issuing a new ultimatum to head off a move that other Western and Middle Eastern powers warned could further inflame regional tensions.** **A6**
- ◆ **Italy and Spain dispatched navy vessels to protect a flotilla carrying international activists aiming to bring aid to Gaza.** **A6**

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French Ex-President Sarkozy Sentenced to Prison



STUNNING FALL: Former French President Nicolas Sarkozy received a five-year sentence Thursday after he was found guilty of conspiring to seek campaign funds from the Gadhafi regime in 2007. He stood with his wife, Carla Bruni, and vowed to appeal. **A6**

Ex-FBI Head Comey Indicted As Trump Presses for Payback

Charges center on 2020 testimony; former director asserts innocence

By SADIE GURMAN

A federal grand jury in Virginia indicted former FBI Director James Comey on Thursday on charges of making false statements and obstruction, days after President Trump demanded the prosecution and ousted the U.S. attorney who determined there was insufficient evidence to bring the case.

Comey had been under investigation for what prosecutors said were lies he told during 2020 congressional testimony during a hearing about the bureau's earlier investigation of the Trump campaign's ties to Russia in the 2016 election. Prosecutors had raced to obtain the indictment, as the statute of limitations on such a case was due to run out next week. "JUSTICE IN AMERICA!" Trump, a Republican, posted on social media after the indictment. "He has been so bad for our Country, for so long, and is now at the beginning of

being held responsible for his crimes against our Nation." In a video posted on Instagram, Comey said: "My family and I have known for years that there are costs to standing up to Donald Trump." He added: "My heart is broken for the Department of Justice but I have great confidence in the federal judicial system. I'm innocent so let's have a trial." An arraignment was scheduled for Oct. 9, according to court records. Democrats criticized the case as an abuse of power. "Donald Trump has made clear that he intends to turn our jus-

tice system into a weapon for punishing and silencing his critics," said Sen. Mark Warner of Virginia. "Our system depends on prosecutors making decisions based on evidence and the law, not on the personal grudges of a politician determined to settle scores." The charges come after Trump publicly questioned why the Justice Department hadn't brought cases against several of his adversaries including Comey and called on

◆ DOJ wants probe of group funded by Soros..... A3

Justices Tackle Fed's Independence

By NICK TIMIRAOS

The Supreme Court is poised to decide whether President Trump can remove Lisa Cook from the Federal Reserve's board, in a case that economists and former Fed officials say threatens to severely erode decades of central bank independence. Trump's broad challenge over interest-rate policy, which began with criticism but has moved to action to remove governors, "represents an existen-

tial crisis for the Fed," said Ethan Harris, former head of global economic research at Bank of America. The Trump administration has asked the Supreme Court to overturn lower court rulings that said Cook could stay on the job while she challenges the White House's attempt to fire her. A ruling in favor of the White House wouldn't necessarily be the final word on the matter. But analysts said it would be a crucial development that opens the door for

Trump to replace other Fed governors, flattening 90 years of legal precedent that insulated central bank officials from political control. "That's sort of the nightmare scenario if you believe in Fed independence," said Harvard economist Kenneth Rogoff, who wrote a seminal paper on central-bank independence in 1985. "If Trump succeeds with Lisa Cook, what's to stop him from targeting other governors and take them down one by one?"

Rogoff was one of 18 signatories on a friend-of-the-court brief filed urging the Supreme Court to let Cook stay on the job for now. The brief was signed by every living former Fed chair—Alan Greenspan, Ben Bernanke and Janet Yellen—as well as senior economic advisers to Republican and Democratic presidents. Cook's legal challenge has become the defining battle in Trump's effort to reshape the relationship between the White

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Amazon To Pay \$2.5 Billion Settlement

By DAVE MICHAELS AND ERIN MULVANEY

Amazon agreed to pay \$2.5 billion to settle Federal Trade Commission allegations that it duped tens of millions of customers into signing up for its Prime service and made it very difficult to cancel. The e-commerce giant will pay a \$1 billion civil penalty, the largest in FTC history, and create a \$1.5 billion fund to pay consumers, according to court documents. Its Prime interface will be required to include a simple way to cancel. Amazon agreed to settle the case—just days into a civil trial—without admitting or denying the FTC's allegations that it misled customers in violation of federal consumer-protection laws. The company said Thursday that the resolution allowed it to move forward and focus on its business. Its current

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INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Starbucks to slash office jobs, close stores in its latest moves to trim costs. **B1**



MANSION
Inside the slow, sometimes messy effort to rebuild Sanibel after Hurricane Ian. **M1**

Meet the People Who Eat 100-Year-Old Military Rations

Novelty trumps taste for these enthusiasts; Civil War cracker, peaches from Vietnam

By DAVID WIGNALL

Nathan Abernathy reviews all kinds of foods, but the meal he was about to dig into was special. It had been prepared in 1965.

The Missouri resident had secured a U.S. military ration from the Vietnam War. On the menu? Canned pork slices, tinned peaches, crackers, a pastry and

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White House Discord Fueled Epstein Crisis

Finger-pointing and unforced errors by Trump advisers made problems worse

President Trump had reached his limit. It was mid-July, and some of his longtime allies were whipping up the audience at a conference in Tampa by

By Josh Dawsey, Rebecca Ballhaus and C. Ryan Barber

complaining that his administration wasn't delivering the real story on Jeffrey Epstein, as his aides had promised. "How many of you are satisfied—you can clap—with the results of the Epstein investigation?" Fox News host Laura Ingraham asked on the first day of the event organized by Turning Point USA, the group co-founded by Charlie Kirk. The crowd erupted in boos and shouts of "not satisfied." Trump, who had socialized with Epstein in New York and

Federal Shutdown Looms as Divisions Deepen

Democrats call threat to fire agency workers 'extortion,' vow to hold the line

WASHINGTON—The U.S. government is hurtling toward a shutdown in a matter of days with no exit ramp in sight, as Republicans and Democrats latch on to starkly different positions and the White House threatens to lay off more federal workers.

By Lindsay Wise, Ken Thomas and Katy Stech Ferek

Republicans are seeking a seven-week extension in federal funding at current levels, and they have dismissed Democrats' demands for hundreds of billions of dollars in healthcare spending. In a move to raise the political pressure, President Trump's budget chief vowed late Wednesday to use any lapse in funding to make deeper cuts in the federal workforce, a threat Democrats rejected as blackmail.

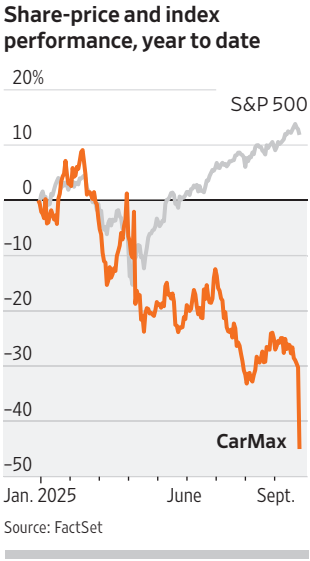
Democrats see the funding deadline as an opportunity to shape legislation, and the party's base voters are desperate for elected representatives to show more fight after months of political defeats. Republicans are loath to offer any

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◆ Trump to place new tariffs on drug firms, trucks..... A5

Auto Sales Flash Alarm

CarMax sales and profit for the quarter plunged, the latest hit for the industry. **B1**



Source: FactSet